

Effective Interdisciplinary Teams
Colleen Cuddy,
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Workshop Worksheet

1) Individual Reflection

- What kind of team are you?
- Where does your team fall on the continuum? Where would you like it to be?
- How does your work connect to others on the team?
- Does your level of interdependence match your team type?
- Do your team's processes align with its level of interdependence?

2) Exercise: Rate Your Team Using Foundational Principles*

On a scale of 1 (worst) to 5 (best), rate your team on these criteria:

Real Team

Are there appropriate team boundaries? Does everyone understand their roles and the roles of others?

Overall Rating:

Compelling Direction

Is there a common goal and vision that is clear, challenging, and consequential? Are goals articulated and shared?

Overall Rating:

Structure

Do we have the right number and mix of members? Do we have clear norms for acceptable conduct? Does our structured time together help us meet our goals and deliver to our stakeholders?

Overall Rating:

Support

Do we have the resources, information, and training we need? Are there appropriate awards for success?

Overall Rating:

Coaching

Have we analyzed our processes? Is team coaching available?

Overall Rating:

Psychological Safety

Do I feel comfortable asking a question, even if I worry it might sound basic or uninformed? If I made a mistake on this team, would I feel safe admitting it, or would I fear it would be held against me? Can I challenge an idea or proposed direction, regardless of who suggested it (e.g., the PI or a senior member)?

Overall Rating: On a scale of 1 (Very Unsafe) to 5 (Completely Safe), how would you rate the psychological safety on your team?

Inclusive Leadership

Does our team leader intentionally seek out opinions from all team members, especially those who are quieter or from underrepresented disciplines? When I contribute an idea, do I feel that it is genuinely heard and considered? Are contributions from all members—regardless of their role, seniority, or background—visibly valued and acknowledged?

Overall Rating: On a scale of 1 (Not at all Inclusive) to 5 (Highly Inclusive), how would you rate the leadership on your team?

Deliberate Processes & Practices

Is it clear to everyone on the team how key decisions are made? When disagreements arise, do we have a clear and productive way to resolve them, or do we tend to avoid conflict? Have we explicitly discussed and agreed upon our norms for communication (e.g., meeting agendas, response times, preferred channels)?

Overall Rating: On a scale of 1 (Chaotic/Assumed) to 5 (Clear/Intentional), how would you rate your team's processes?

**Adapted from: Haas, M & Mortensen, M. The secrets of great teamwork. Harvard Business Review. June 2016 p. 71-76*